

Information Security & Acceptable Use Policy

Requirements for protecting Company systems, devices, and data

Effective Date	July 15, 2025	Policy Owner	IT Security Team
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1. Purpose

This policy defines the minimum security requirements for accessing, using, and protecting Northfield Analytics, Inc. information systems, devices, and data. It exists to reduce the risk of data breaches, malware infection, and unauthorized access to Company and client information.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, and third parties who access Company networks, applications, or data, whether using Company-issued or personal (BYOD) devices.

3. Acceptable Use

Company systems and accounts are provided for business purposes. Users must:

- Use their own individual login credentials and never share passwords or access tokens.
- Lock or log off devices when unattended, including in home offices.
- Install only software approved by IT or obtained through the Company's managed app catalog.
- Report lost or stolen devices to IT Security within 2 hours of discovery.

4. Password and Authentication Requirements

All Company accounts must use a unique password of at least 14 characters and multi-factor authentication (MFA) wherever it is offered. Passwords must not be reused across personal and Company accounts, written down in plain sight, or shared via email or chat.

Passwords must be rotated immediately upon suspicion of compromise and are subject to forced rotation if a breach is detected on a connected system.

5. Data Classification

All Company data must be handled according to its classification level:

Classification	Description	Handling Requirement
Public	Approved for external release	No restriction
Internal	General business information	Company network only; no public posting
Confidential	Client data, contracts, financials	Encrypted at rest and in transit; need-to-know access
Restricted	Credentials, PII, security findings	Encrypted; access logged; approval required to share

6. Incident Reporting

Any suspected security incident — including phishing emails, malware alerts, unauthorized access, or lost devices — must be reported immediately to security@northfieldanalytics.example or via the #security-incidents Slack channel. Do not attempt to investigate or remediate a suspected breach without guidance from IT Security.

7. Prohibited Activities

The following are strictly prohibited on Company systems:

- Disabling or bypassing endpoint security software (antivirus, disk encryption, MDM).
- Connecting to Company systems over public Wi-Fi without an active VPN connection.
- Transmitting Confidential or Restricted data to personal email or unapproved cloud storage.
- Using Company systems to engage in illegal activity or to harass others.

8. Enforcement

Violations of this policy may result in suspension of system access, disciplinary action up to termination, and, where applicable, referral to law enforcement. IT Security may quarantine or disconnect any device found to be non-compliant to protect the broader network.

Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	Aug 2021	IT Security	Initial policy release.
1.3	Oct 2023	IT Security	Added data classification table.

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
2.0	Jul 2025	IT Security	Mandated MFA and VPN-on-public-Wi-Fi requirements.